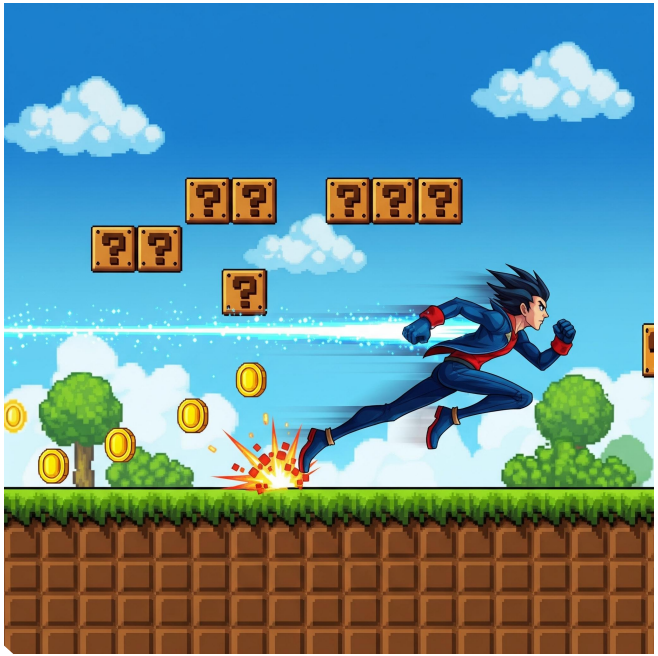
Speedrunning 101

What, why and how?

What is Speedrunning?



- **An attempt to beat a video game quickly**

Analogies: Sports vs Speedrunning

- Usual sports moved to the online space as **esports**
- **Team sports** -> Dota/Lol



- Individual disciplines resemble **speedrunning's** solo focus



Analogies with sport continue: Watch or Do!

- Speedrunning can be **watched** and **enjoyed** as a sport
- Spectate speedrunning competitions like traditional sports events

  or

- Participate in speedrunning challenges individually



My journey and the community

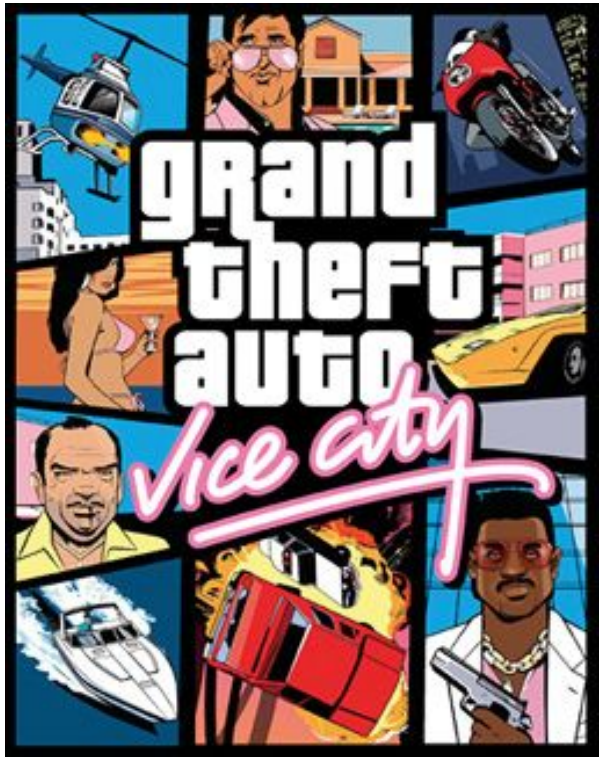
WR is 37 minutes.



38	Nobody1441	49m 10s	Wii U	3 ye
39	benG_boy	49m 25s	PC	4 ye
40	dax_	49m 26s	PC	4 ye
41	Pikapete2688	49m 33s	PC	3 ye
42	rikodlc	49m 45s	PS4	3 ye
42	tinkerknight	49m 45s	PC	7 mo
44	KC27	49m 50s	PC	3 ye
45	Squeal			
46	Notztriumph			
47	Desticler			
48	localmocal			
49	Lexingway			
50	Kirili4ik			
51	Primorix	51m 44s	PC	4 ye
52	Samus_Supreme	52m 20s	PC	4 ye
53	BordynConfused	53m 14s	PC	9 mo
54	MechTech	53m 15s	XboxOne	4 ye
54	Korruptz	53m 15s	PC	2 ye
56	figment10	53m 42s	PC	2 ye

55	Lexingway	50m 52s	8 years ago	Switch
56	Kirili4ik	51m 16s	4 years ago	PS4
57	Primorix	51m 44s	8 years ago	PC

How to beat video game quickly?



1 - Choose a game and visit speedrun.com

2 - Choose a category

- «Any%»
- «100%» / «All bosses»
- «Glitchless»
- specific-to-game

SPEEDRUN.COM Games Challenges Forums Help ⋮ SUPPORTER Search... / Log in Sign up

LATEST RUNS



Factorio: Space Age

Random Seed New Game+ (2.0.66) — 1st — 4h 09m 43s — DerekMacIntyre — 1 hour ago



Monster Girls and the Mysterious Adventure Remastered Edition

STORY/ストーリーRTA — 1st — 1h 35m 27s — andanteyk — 1 hour ago



007: The World is Not Enough

Level: King's Ransom
Agent — 3rd — 1m 21s — bigtomiman — 1 hour ago



Deepwoken

Trial of One
Enchants Allowed (Adret) — 1st — 3m 34s 783ms — dusttt — 1 hour ago



ULTRAKILL

Level: 0-3: Double Down
Any%
Post-Revamp (-- EA (2/24/25) --, Inbounds) — 1st — 0m 06s 945ms — Kolta — 1 hour ago

Level: 1-2: The Burning World
Any%
Post-Revamp (-- EA (2/24/25) --) — 16th — 0m 20s 688ms — Solomonn — 3 hours ago



Splatoon

Any% No World 4 Early
WiiU — 1st — 49m 19s — Negat — 2 hours ago

CHALLENGES



Live Premium
Shinobi: Art of Vengeance (2025)
Dark Katana Challenge

Ends in
7d 13h 22s

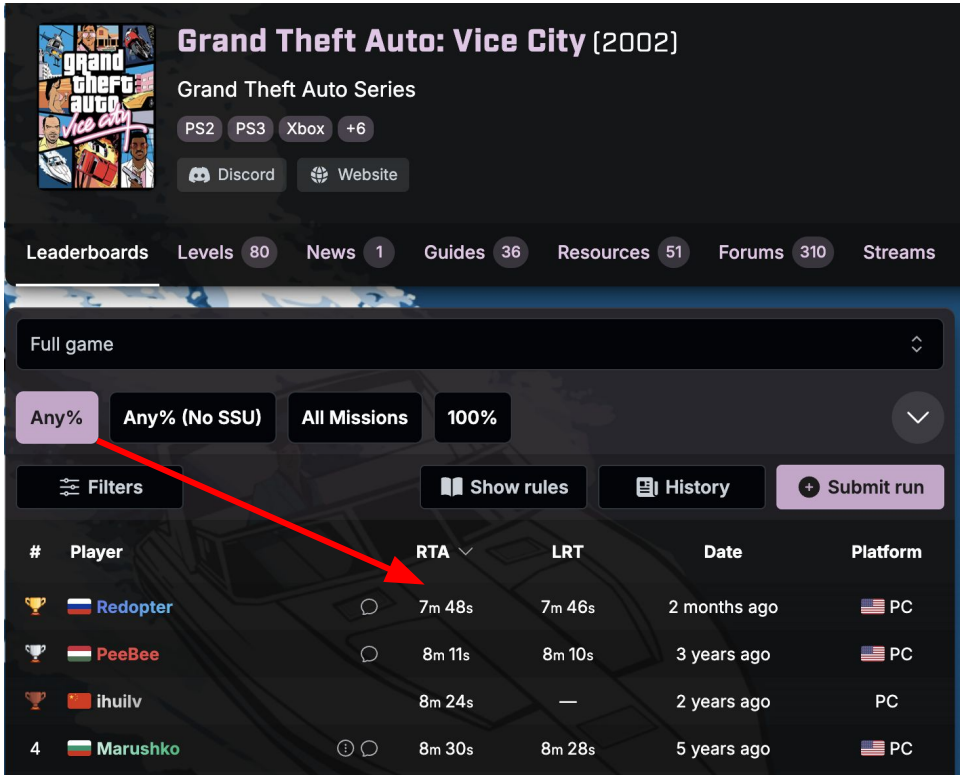
COMMUNITY NEWS

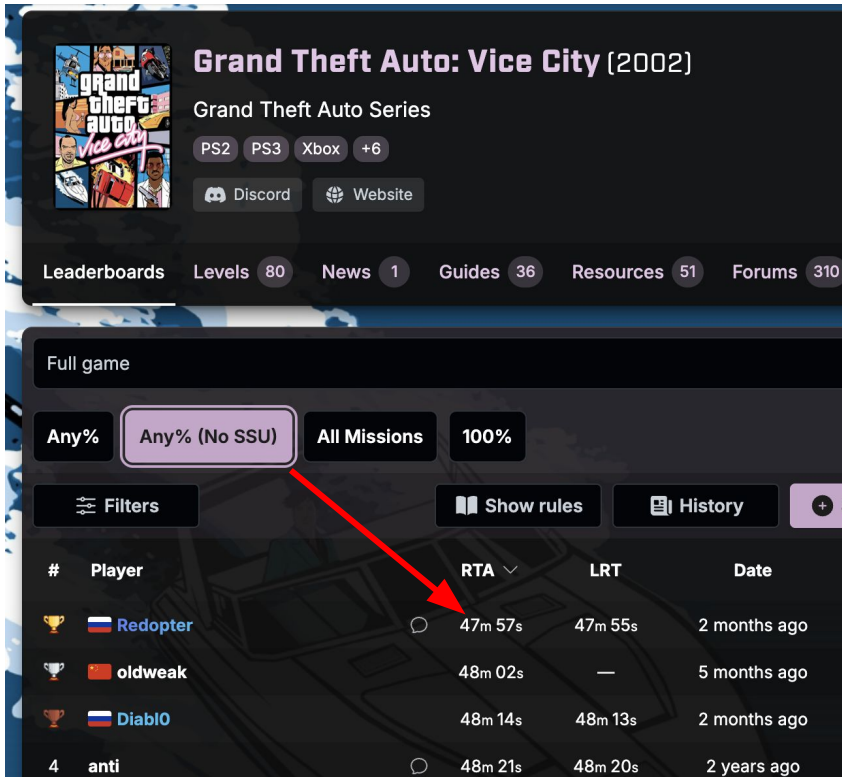
SITE NEWS
SHINOBI Dark Katana Challenge Begins... 2 days ago
The Dark Katana does not yield easily, its power comes at a price - your sanity.
Meta 1

Wii Play BREAK the Record - The LTA Que... 10 days ago
9 days. 9 games. 9 balls. After a popular series-wide LTA earlier this year, the Wii Series Speedrunning community are...
SMMidi 4

SITE NEWS
The JETRUNNER Marathon Challenge... 19 days ago
Welcome to JETRUNNER - where gravity is optional, style is mandatory, and milliseconds make legends.
Meta 6

SITE NEWS
SHINOBI Ninja Legacy Challenge Begins... 1 month ago
Speedrun.com is proud to present a legacy challenge forged across time worthy of the blade.
Meta 3


Grand Theft Auto: Vice City (2002)
Grand Theft Auto Series
PS2 PS3 Xbox +6
Discord Website
Leaderboards Levels 80 News 1 Guides 36 Resources 51 Forums 310 Streams
Full game
Any% Any% (No SSU) All Missions 100%
Filters Show rules History Submit run
Player RTA LRT Date Platform
Redopter 7m 48s 7m 46s 2 months ago PC
PeeBee 8m 11s 8m 10s 3 years ago PC
ihuilv 8m 24s — 2 years ago PC
4 Marushko 8m 30s 8m 28s 5 years ago PC


Grand Theft Auto: Vice City (2002)
Grand Theft Auto Series
PS2 PS3 Xbox +6
Discord Website
Leaderboards Levels 80 News 1 Guides 36 Resources 51 Forums 310
Full game
Any% Any% (No SSU) All Missions 100%
Filters Show rules History
Player RTA LRT Date
Redopter 47m 57s 47m 55s 2 months ago
oldweak 48m 02s — 5 months ago
DiablO 48m 14s 48m 13s 2 months ago
4 anti 48m 21s 48m 20s 2 years ago

Finishing up?

Game chosen

Category chosen

Step 3 – **??? become faster ???**

Step 4 – Profit!

Time-saving — Skill



Time-saving — Luck



Time-saving — Serious glitches (Out Of Bounds)



Time-saving — Serious glitches (inf. height and duplication)







Speedrunning is different

- Depends on:
  - Game
  - Category
  - Skill
  - Glitches (yes/no/less)





SATANHERSELF

Plants Vs Zombies
PC

Roof

34:16.10

ESTIMATED | 1:00:00



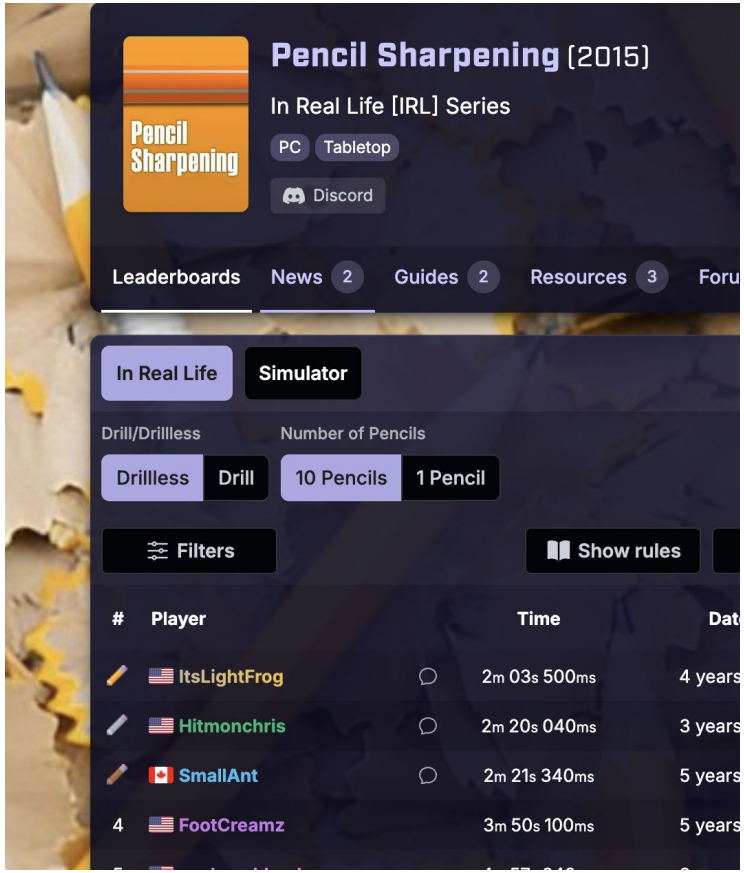
FAST 52

GIVES YOU WIIINGS.

$12,733
TOTAL RAISED

Spin The Wheel
$12,733 $25,000

cm_reaver: pog
apollyian:
OnlyShadow767: @sweenyshaq
looeesz:
LobsturTFT: 2011 second grade


Pencil Sharpening
Pencil Sharpening (2015)
In Real Life [IRL] Series
PC
Tabletop
Discord
Leaderboards
News 2
Guides 2
Resources 3
In Real Life
Simulator
Drill/Drillless
Number of Pencils
Drillless
Drill
10 Pencils
1 Pencil
Filters
Show rules
Player Time
ItsLightFrog 2m 03s 500ms 4 years
Hitmonchris 2m 20s 040ms 3 years
SmallAnt 2m 21s 340ms 5 years
4 FootCreamz 3m 50s 100ms 5 years


Sub Goal: 12,481/13,000
SMO Any%
@SMALLANT1
cmon!
FOR
GET
10
5:26
3:23.37
3:23.37

SummoningSalt @ youtube - speedrunning history videos



Mario Kart Wii: The History of the Ultra Shortcut

13M views • 6 years ago



4-2: The History of Super Mario Bros.' Most Infamous Level

9.8M views • 7 years ago



Mike Tyson's Punch-Out!! Former World Record Speed Run in 15:12.14

9.4M views • 8 years ago



Super Mario Bros: The Human Limit

8.6M views • 4 years ago



The History of Super Mario 64 16 Star World Records

8M views • 3 years ago



World Record Progression: Pokemon Red/Blue speedruns

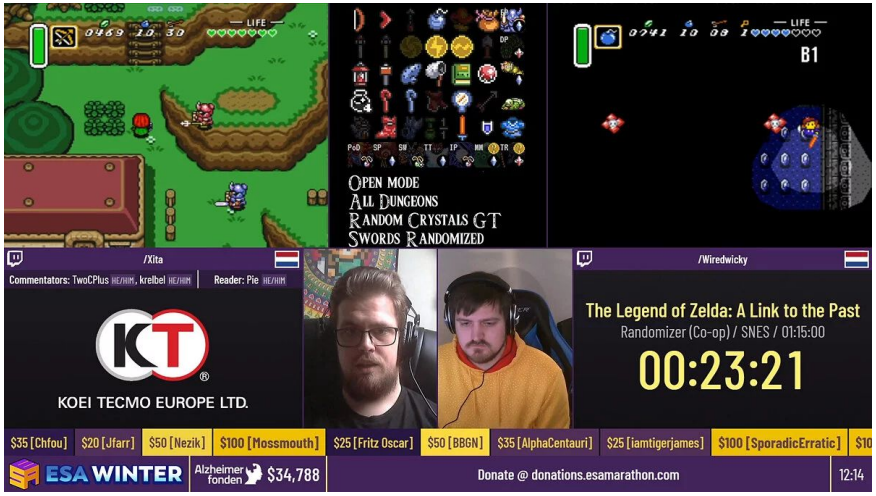
7M views • 7 years ago

This is already super popular

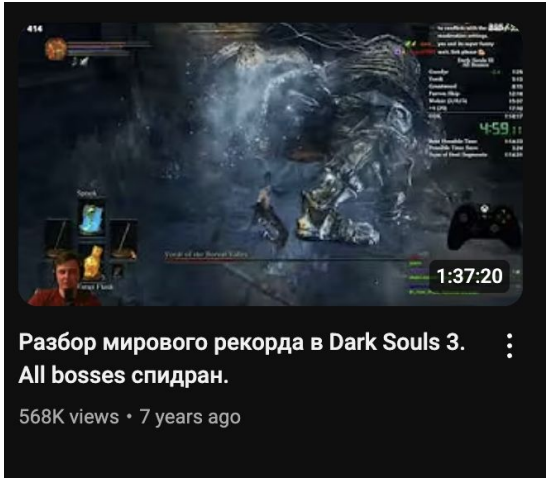
youtube.com/watch?v=_XkKufyIiAY – wii golf speedrunning

More recommendations

https://gamesdonequick.com/ — Games Done Quick



https://www.youtube.com/@KarmikKoala (rus) — reviews and explanations



Why Speedrunning Rocks

- Watching
- Playing
- Your favourite game
- Friendly & passionate community
- Learn game mechanics and glitches
- Pure entertainment and fun!



Resources: events, tutorials, etc

https://www.speedrun.com

https://gamesdonequick.com

https://fast.ludwig.gg/ – charity event that took place this weekends

Resources: Speedrunners

https://twitch.tv/distortion2 (most popular speedrunner I believe)

http://twitch.tv/themexicanrunner (retro games speedrunner & cuphead wr holder)

http://twitch.tv/karmikkoala (speedruns reviewer & tournaments in Russian)

https://www.youtube.com/@Smallant (party speedrunner (Zelda, pencil sharpening wr) & youtuber)


Getting Over It
TAS 2
with AS13B

TAS - Tool Assisted Speedrun

